



POE- PART 1

RESEARCH

OPEN – SOURCE CODING
OPSC6312



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CHLOE JADE LANGENHOVEN
ST10435895

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YOUTHLINK SA

“YOUR NEXT OPPORTUNITY STARTS HERE.”

Youth Job Opportunities Research Report

Introduction

Many young people in South Africa face challenges when trying to move from education into employment or further education because they tend to struggle to find opportunities after school or after finishing their studies. A young person may first need to decide what career they want or even still find a suitable qualification. Some people are looking for jobs, while others want to study further, find funding for their studies, gain practical experience or develop new skills before becoming ready for employment. Finding an opportunity is not always simply a matter of searching for a job. It can also be difficult for young people to know where to look for these opportunities, especially fresh out of school. Some might not know which university/institution course to choose from, which bursary they qualify for, where to find an internship, or what jobs are available if they do not have much experience.

There are already existing platforms that address different parts of these problems. **SA Youth** provides young South Africans with access to work, learning, skills-development, youth and entrepreneurial opportunities (SAYouth, n.d). **LinkedIn** focuses on professional networking, job and internship searching, professional profiles and career development (LinkedIn, n.d). **Youth Jobs South Africa** focuses on youth employment and early-career opportunities, including entry-level jobs, internships, learnerships, graduate opportunities and other opportunities aimed at young South Africans (youthjobs.co.za, n.d).

The purpose of this research is therefore not simply to identify existing applications. It is to investigate how these platforms solve the youth unemployment problem, what they do well, where there are opportunities for improvement and which features/ideas could be used in the design of **YouthLink SA**.

YouthLink SA aims to bring various stages of a young person’s journey together in one application. These will include career exploration and information, study opportunities, bursaries, skills development programmes, internships, work-integrated learning, learnerships, entry-level employment, graduate opportunities, jobs, entrepreneurship and volunteering.

Existing Platform Research

The three platforms selected for this research are:

- 1. SA Youth**
- 2. LinkedIn**
- 3. Youth Jobs SA**

I'll also use WhatsApp Channels as supporting research because Youth Jobs uses WhatsApp to distribute opportunities to its audience. Youth Jobs currently reports reaching more than 21,000 young job seekers through its WhatsApp channel (youthjobs.co.za, n.d).

1. SA Youth

Overview

SA Youth is a South African platform designed to help young people access work, learning and development opportunities. It is mainly aimed at unemployed young South Africans and forms part of the Presidential Youth Employment Intervention. Users can find different types of opportunities, including jobs, youth programmes, entrepreneurial opportunities and skills-development programmes (SAYouth, n.d). The platform also provides resources such as job-search information, interview tips and digital-skills support (SAYouth, n.d).

One of the useful features of SA Youth is that it is free and does not require mobile data, which makes it more accessible to young people who may have limited financial resources. Users can also receive assistance from SA Youth guides when registering and applying for opportunities (SAYouth, n.d).

SA Youth is therefore more than just a job-search platform because it supports young people with different steps towards employment, including finding opportunities, gaining skills and preparing for work.

Strengths

- Provides different types of opportunities in one platform.
- Focuses specifically on young South Africans.
- Includes learning and skills-development opportunities, not only jobs.
- Free to use and designed to reduce data costs.
- Provides support for users who need help applying.
- Allows opportunities to be connected to a user's location.

Weaknesses

- The platform is mainly focused on earning and learning opportunities and does not provide as much detailed career exploration for high school learners.
- Users still need to understand what career or opportunity they are interested in before searching.
- It does not combine the full journey of **career exploration → studying → funding → skills → internships → employment** in one structured system.
- Some opportunities may have specific requirements, which could make it difficult for young people who do not have matric, qualifications or previous experience.

Innovative Features

The most useful idea from SAYouth is the way it brings different opportunities together instead of only showing permanent jobs. This is useful for YouthLink SA because a young person may need a learnership, skills programme, internship or volunteering opportunity before they are ready for permanent employment.

The platform's free/no-data approach is also useful because accessibility is important when designing an application for South African youth.

How I think it was implemented

Based on our knowledge of Android Studio, we think a similar application could use multiple screens connected through navigation, with categories for different opportunities. A user profile could store information such as location, interests and employment status. A database or API could then provide opportunity information based on the user's details.

For YouthLink SA, we could use a similar structure but make the categories easier to understand and add career exploration, education and funding options.

UI Screens

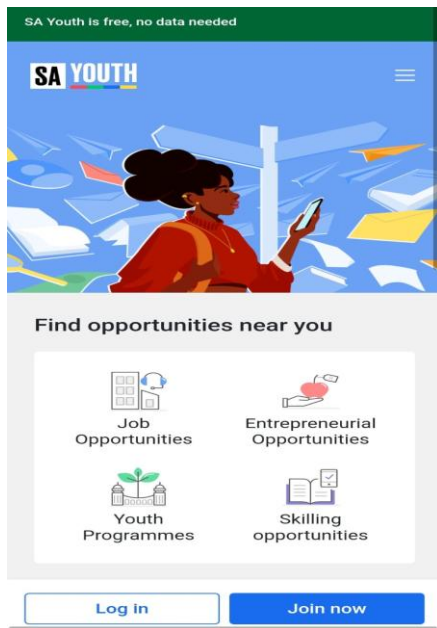


Figure 1: SA Youth Join Page

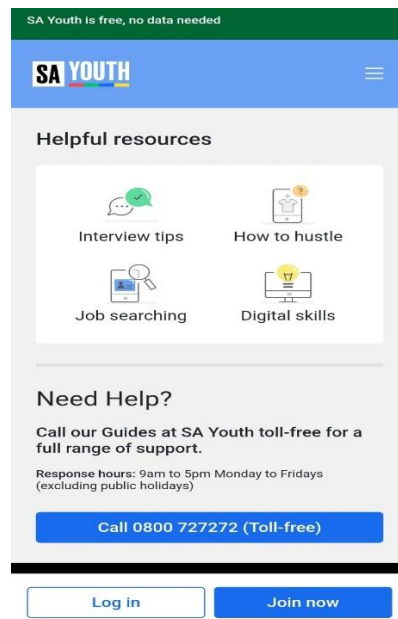


Figure 2: SA Youth Join Page

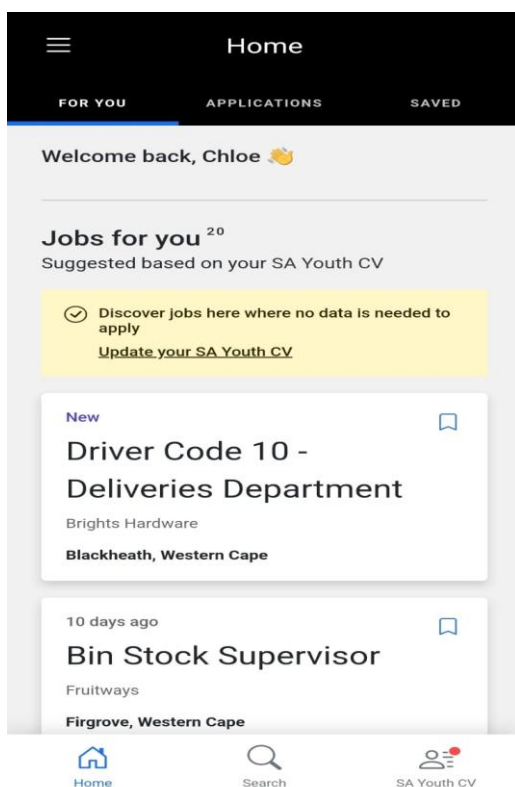


Figure 4: SA Youth Home Page

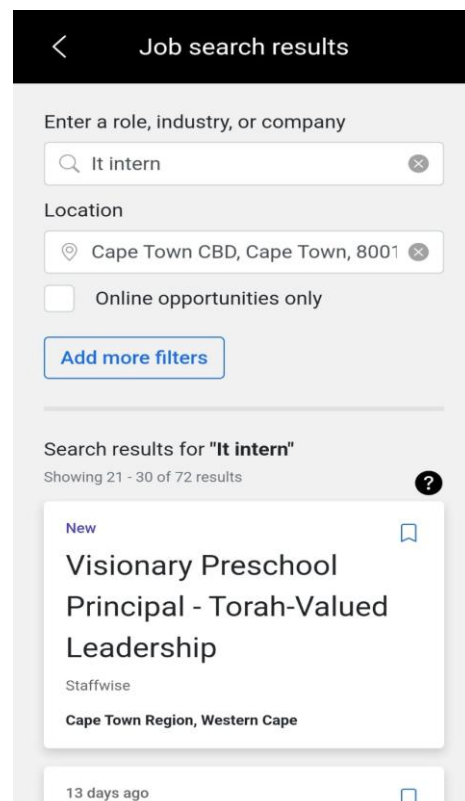


Figure 3: Job Search Results

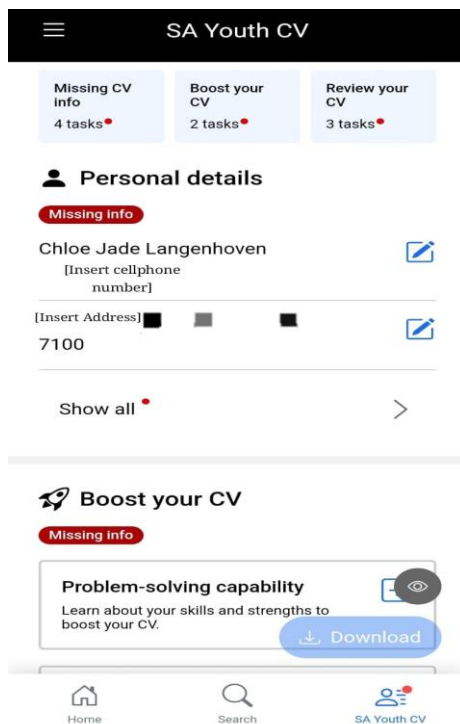


Figure 5: CV Page

2. LinkedIn

Overview

LinkedIn is a professional networking and employment platform that allows people to create a professional profile, search for jobs and internships, develop their careers and connect with other professionals (LinkedIn, n.d). Users can add information such as their education, skills, work experience and other achievements to their profile (LinkedIn, n.d).

LinkedIn's Jobs section allows users to search for opportunities using keywords and filters such as location, experience level, employment type and industry (LinkedIn, n.d). Users can also save jobs and create job alerts so that they can be notified when suitable opportunities become available (LinkedIn, n.d).

LinkedIn can also recommend jobs based on information in a user's profile and their selected preferences (LinkedIn , n.d). This makes the platform more personalised because users can receive opportunities that match their skills, interests and experience.

Strengths

- Professional profile works similarly to an online CV.
- Users can add education, skills and experience.
- Strong job and internship search features.
- Provides filters to narrow down opportunities.
- Allows users to save jobs.

- Provides personalised job recommendations.
- Job alerts can notify users about new opportunities.
- Allows users to build professional connections.

Weaknesses

- LinkedIn is designed for a broad professional audience and is not specifically designed around the needs of South African youth.
- It can feel overwhelming for high school learners or people who have never worked before.
- Users are expected to understand professional careers and job titles.
- People with little or no experience may struggle to make their profile stand out.
- It focuses heavily on professional employment rather than helping someone decide what they want to study or what career they should choose.

Innovative Features

The most useful idea from LinkedIn is its professional profile and personalised job searching. Instead of making users search through every available job, the platform can use information such as skills, location and preferences to suggest relevant opportunities.

This inspired our idea for a YouthLink SA profile/CV builder where young people can enter their education, skills, interests and experience, even if they have very little work experience.

How I think it was implemented

Based on our knowledge of Android Studio, we think LinkedIn could use activities/fragments or Jetpack Compose screens for the profile, jobs and networking sections. User information would likely be stored in a database, while job information could be retrieved from an API or backend system.

A search system would allow users to enter keywords and apply filters. A recommendation system could then compare the user's profile information with available jobs.

For YouthLink SA, we want to use a simpler version of this idea that is easier for young people to understand.

UI Screens

All jobs filters

Distance

☐ 10 miles (16 km)

☒ 25 miles (40 km)

☐ 50 miles (80 km)

☐ 75 miles (120 km)

☐ 100 miles (160 km)

Sort by

☒ Most relevant

☐ Most recent

LinkedIn Features

☐ Easy Apply (1,997)

☐ Under 10 Applicants (46,608)

☐ In Your Network (1,488)

☐ Fair Chance Employer (914) ⓘ

Job Type

☐ Full-time (46,310)

☐ Part-time (3,863)

☐ Volunteer (1,998)

☐ Contract (1,539)

☐ Temporary (1,151)

☐ Other (804)

☐ Internship (285)

Figure 6: LinkedIn Job Filters

in

HomeMy NetworkJobsMessagingNotificationsMeWorkLearning

Saved JobsApplied JobsJob AlertsSalaryMore

Post a job

Search for your next job

Search by title, skill, or company

City, state, or zip code

Search

Job searches

Manage Alerts

sales manager (1 new)
Seoul, South Korea

product manager (3 new)
Seoul, South Korea

senior brand manager
Seoul, Seoul, South Korea

marketing manager
Seoul, South Korea

Figure 7: LinkedIn Job Search

in

Search

HomeMy networkJobsMessagingNotificationsMeWork

Joe Sample

Sales Specialist at Sample Company

Country · Contact info

Open to

Add section

More

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed diam nonummy nibh euismod tincidunt ut.

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed diam nonummy nibh euismod tincidunt ut.

Edit public profile & URL

Add profile in another language

Ad

Follow

People also viewed

Joe Sample

Sample · Sample

Follow

Figure 8: LinkedIn Profile

8 | Page

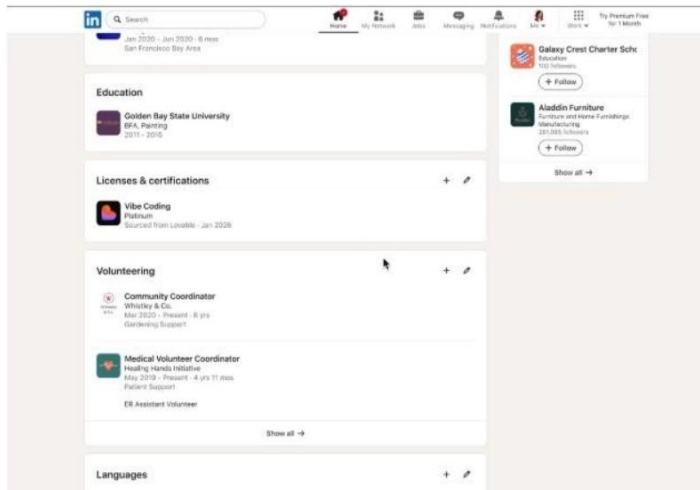


Figure 9: LinkedIn Profile

3. Youth Jobs SA

Overview

YouthJobs.co.za is a South African platform focused on helping young people find jobs and early-career opportunities. The platform was established in 2012 and focuses on connecting school-leavers and graduates with opportunities such as entry-level jobs, internships, learnerships and other early-career positions (youthjobs.co.za, n.d).

The platform also provides career-support resources such as CV-building assistance and interview tips. This makes it useful for young people who may be looking for their first job and do not have much experience (youthjobs.co.za, n.d).

Another feature that is useful for our research is its WhatsApp presence. Youth Jobs reports that its WhatsApp channel reaches more than 21,000 young job seekers, allowing opportunities and information to reach young people through a platform that many already use (youthjobs.co.za, n.d).

Strengths

- Specifically focuses on young South Africans.
- Provides entry-level opportunities.
- Includes internships and learnerships.
- Useful for school-leavers and graduates.
- Provides career and CV support.
- Includes opportunities across different industries.
- Uses WhatsApp to reach young people.

Weaknesses

- Mainly focuses on employment and early-career opportunities.
- Does not provide a complete career-planning journey.

- Does not focus strongly on helping high school learners decide what career they want.
- Study options and funding are not the main focus.
- Users may still need to search elsewhere for universities, colleges and bursaries.

Innovative Features

The main idea we would take from Youth Jobs is its strong focus on entry-level and early-career opportunities. This is important because many young people struggle to find jobs because they do not have previous experience.

YouthLink SA will build on this by including entry-level jobs, internships, WIL opportunities, learnerships, graduate programmes and part-time opportunities.

The use of WhatsApp also showed us that opportunities can be shared through platforms that young people already use instead of expecting them to constantly check a website.

How I think it was implemented

Based on our knowledge of Android Studio, we think the platform could use screens for different opportunity categories, with a database containing information such as the job title, company, location, requirements, closing date and application link.

For YouthLink SA, we could improve this by allowing users to filter opportunities according to their career interests, qualifications, experience, location and opportunity type.

UI Screens

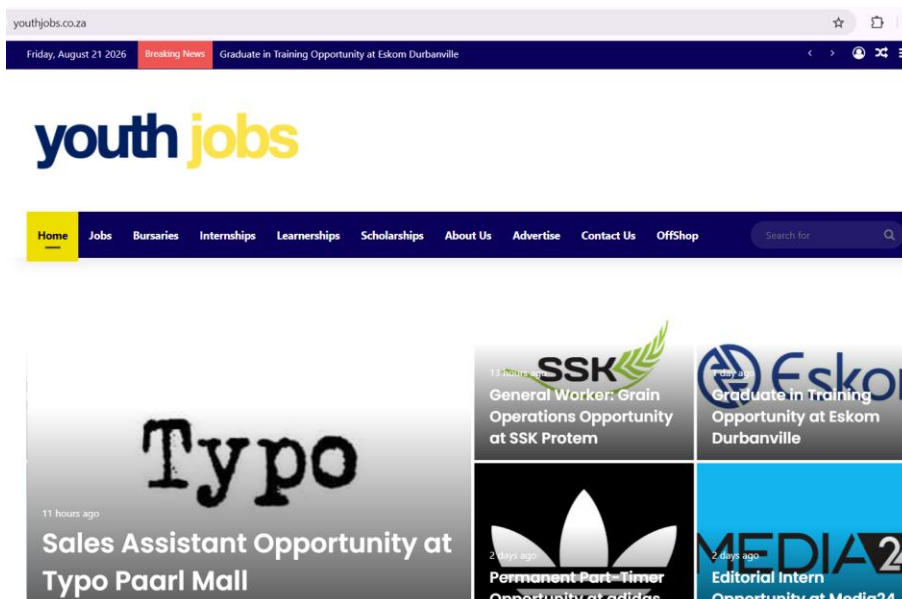


Figure 10: Youth Jobs SA Dashboard

Comparison of the Three Platforms

For the comparison, I agree with you that we should only compare SAYouth, LinkedIn and Youth Jobs South Africa. We don't need to bring WhatsApp into the main comparison because we're using it as supporting research.

WHAT MAKES EACH PLATFORM DIFFERENT?			
Key differences at a glance			
	 SAYouth sayouth.mobi	 LinkedIn	 Youth Jobs SA youthjobs.co.za
 Main Focus	Work, learning and development opportunities for young South Africans.	Professional networking, career growth and job searching.	Entry-level and early-career opportunities for young South Africans.
 Opportunity Types	Jobs, skills programmes, youth programmes, entrepreneurial and learning opportunities.	Jobs, internships, learning, freelance work and professional connections.	Entry-level jobs, internships, learnerships, bursaries, graduate and part-time opportunities.
 Purpose	Helps young people gain skills, prepare for work and access different opportunities.	Build a professional identity and connect with opportunities and people.	Help young people get their first experience and enter the workforce.
 Target Audience	Unemployed South African youth (18 – 34 years old). Criteria: 18 – 34 years old and must have a South African (or refugee) ID or valid work permit.	Students, professionals and job seekers globally.	Young South Africans, school-leavers, graduates and job seekers.
 Access	100% free and no data required on supported networks.	Free basic access with optional premium features.	Free to use.
 Support / Resources	Provides guides, work-readiness training and application support.	Community, articles, courses and professional resources.	CV tips, interview tips and career advice for young job seekers.
 Unique Strength	Government-backed youth platform focused on both earning and learning.	Strong professional profiles, networking and personalised job recommendations.	Strong focus on entry-level opportunities and early-career pathways.
 Outreach / Distribution	Opportunities based on your area.	Global reach with professional networking.	Shares opportunities via website and WhatsApp channel (21 000+ young job seekers reached).
 SA Youth PART OF THE PRESIDENTIAL YOUTH EMPLOYMENT INTERVENTION  harambee YOUTH ECONOMICITY ACCELERATOR  employment & labour Department of Employment and Labour REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA  higher education & training Department of Higher Education and Training REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA  nyda NATIONAL YOUTH DEVELOPMENT AGENCY  YES YOUTH EMPLOYMENT SERVICE  DBSA DEVELOPMENT BANK OF SOUTHERN AFRICA			

Figure 11: Differences of each platform

Similarities

Although the three platforms have different target users and features, they have several similarities:

- **Job opportunities:** All three platforms provide access to employment opportunities.
- **Internships and early-career opportunities:** They can help young people gain experience and move towards employment.
- **Career development:** They provide opportunities or resources that can help users improve their careers.
- **Online searching:** Users can search for opportunities digitally rather than relying only on traditional methods of finding work.
- **Skills and learning:** SAYouth provides work-readiness and learning opportunities (SAYouth, n.d), LinkedIn provides learning resources (LinkedIn, n.d) and Youth Jobs provides career and job-seeking advice.

- **Support for people starting their careers:** Each platform can be useful to someone who is trying to enter or progress in the working world.

These comparison shows that the three platforms all help users access employment and career opportunities, but each platform has a different main focus. These differences helped us identify features that YouthLink SA can combine and improve.

What was identified from the Comparison

The comparison helped us identify that no single platform covers every stage of a young person's journey.

For example, a high school learner may need help deciding what career to follow before they even start looking for a job. A university student may need information about bursaries, internships or Work-Integrated Learning. A graduate may be looking for an entry-level position or graduate programme. Someone who did not complete matric may instead need a skills programme, learnership or job that focuses more on their skills and experience.

This is where YouthLink SA will be different. Instead of focusing only on finding a job, the application will support the user through different stages of their journey, from career exploration and further education to skills development and employment.

Best Features to Implement in YouthLink SA

The research of the three platforms helped me identify features that would be useful for our application. I'm not simply copying the existing platforms. Instead, I'm taking ideas that work well and combining them with features that I believe are missing or could be improved.

Feature	Inspired by / Identified from	Why YouthLink SA Will Use It
<i>Opportunity Search & Filters</i>	<i>SAYouth, LinkedIn, Youth Jobs SA</i>	Users can search and filter opportunities by field, location, type, education, experience and closing date.
<i>Career Exploration</i>	<i>LinkedIn + research gap</i>	Provides simple information about careers, qualifications, possible jobs and study options, helping learners make informed choices.
<i>Study & Funding</i>	<i>SAYouth and Youth Jobs SA</i>	Includes universities, TVET colleges, bursaries, NSFAS and skills programmes, with

Feature	Inspired by / Identified from	Why YouthLink SA Will Use It
		requirements and closing dates where available.
<i>Internships, WIL & Learnerships</i>	<i>SAYouth, LinkedIn, Youth Jobs SA</i>	Helps students and young people with little experience find internships, WIL, learnerships, graduate and entry-level opportunities.
<i>CV/Profile Builder</i>	<i>LinkedIn</i>	Helps users create a basic CV and professional profile using their education, skills, experience and certificates.
<i>Opportunity Matching</i>	<i>SAYouth and LinkedIn</i>	Recommends opportunities based on the user's interests, skills, education, location and preferred opportunity type.
<i>Opportunities Without Matric</i>	<i>Gap identified during research</i>	Includes opportunities that focus on skills, experience and willingness to learn, helping users who do not have matric.
<i>Multiple Languages</i>	<i>YouthLink SA design decision</i>	Supports English, Afrikaans and isiXhosa to improve accessibility.
<i>Notifications</i>	<i>Existing opportunity platforms</i>	Alerts users about new opportunities and approaching closing dates.
<i>Events & Youth Programmes</i>	<i>YouthLink SA design decision</i>	Includes career exhibitions, job fairs, open days, workshops and entrepreneurship events.

Conclusion

The research on SAYouth, LinkedIn and Youth Jobs South Africa showed us that there are already useful platforms that help young people find jobs, learning and career opportunities. However, each platform has a different main focus. SAYouth mainly focuses on work and learning opportunities for unemployed youth, LinkedIn focuses on professional profiles, networking and job opportunities, while Youth Jobs South Africa focuses more on entry-level and early-career opportunities.

Through this research, we were able to identify the useful features and gaps in the existing platforms. Instead of creating an app that only lists job vacancies, YouthLink SA

will bring different opportunities together to support young people at different stages of their journey. These include career exploration, further studies, funding, skills development, internships, WIL, learnerships, entry-level jobs and career preparation.

The findings from the research will directly guide the requirements and design of YouthLink SA. Features such as opportunity searching and filtering, profiles, CV building, opportunity matching, notifications and multiple language options will be included because they address needs identified during the research. The application will also focus on being inclusive by considering young people who have little or no work experience and those who may not have matric.

Therefore, the research provides a strong foundation for the development of YouthLink SA – “Your next opportunity starts here.” The findings will be used in the next sections of the document to develop the system requirements, user interface, navigation and overall application design. This will ensure that the final design is based on the needs identified during our research rather than simply creating features without a clear purpose.

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